RMIT Classification: Trusted

BUSM2580 – CASE STUDY

HOPEBOX

Gender-Based Violence in Vietnam

Gender-based violence (GBV) in Vietnam is a critical issue, deeply rooted in cultural and societal norms. GBV is defined as violence directed against a person based on gender or sex, encompassing physical, mental, or sexual harm, threats, coercion, and deprivations of liberty. While both men and women can be victims, women and girls are predominantly affected. According to the National Study on Violence against Women in Vietnam (2019), a staggering 63% of Vietnamese women have experienced some form of violence from their husbands (MOLISA, GSO & UNFPA, 2020). In there, 32% reported such violence within the last 12 months. This alarming data underscores the urgent need for effective interventions and support systems to protect and empower survivors of GBV in Vietnam.

About HopeBox



HopeBox is a social enterprise founded in 2018 with the mission of empowering marginalized communities and promoting sustainable development in Vietnam. Initially started as a small e-commerce platform, HopeBox has grown into a multifaceted organization that provides job training, mental health support, and entrepreneurship opportunities for survivors of gender-based violence. With a focus on local collaboration and grassroots-led initiatives, HopeBox has become a trusted partner for community-based organizations and government agencies working to address GBV in Vietnam. It officially registered with the Australian Charities and Not-for-profits Commission in 2021. HopeBox's mission is to provide employment and comprehensive support to women who are survivors of gender-based violence. The organization offers a transition model that includes employability skills such as hospitality training, job search skills, and career development, as well as life skills, trauma healing, and work-based therapy.

HopeBox's Vision, Mission and Values

Vision: Hopebox aim to be a pioneer social enterprise in Vietnam that leaves no women or children behind because of gender-based violence.

Misson: HopeBox want to empower our women by giving them a safe place to live, to enable them to earn money and to receive an education. By doing so, we are making it possible for them to live free from sexual abuse and violence and providing them the means to raise their children a non-violent environment.

Value: HopeBox's values are RESPECT

- **R**espect
- **E**mpower
- **S**kills
- **P**artnership
- **E**mployment
- **C**ompassion
- **T**eamwork



HopeBox's Achievements

The company has made significant strides since its inception. One of its major achievements includes supporting GBV survivors through its "women economic empowerment" program. This program helped 15 survivors gain employment skills in 2022. More than 50% of these women have continued their work in the food and beverage industry, earning a minimum salary of 6 million VND per month, and 20% have secured managerial positions. In the past five years, HopeBox has trained over 50 survivors in skills such as handicraft production, digital marketing, and financial management. It has also collaborated with over 50 corporations across Vietnam, including prominent names like Vietnam Airlines, Manulife, Meta, UNIQLO, and AEON, on Environmental, Social, and Governance activities. The organization has successfully organized numerous community events to raise awareness about GBV, notably the "Move for Hope" campaign. In 2023, HopeBox was 1 of 30 social enterprises achieving support from the project "Leveraging Vietnam's social impact business ecosystem in response to Covid-19), sponsored by Global Affairs Canada, UNDP and Ministry of Planning and Investment Vietnam. HopeBox also received the "Én Xanh" Award, a program honoring business initiatives for the community in 2019.

Looking ahead, HopeBox's medium-term future plan includes ensuring financial sustainability, expanding its programs to other provinces, and developing an e-learning platform to reach a broader audience.

Alignment with the UN Sustainable Development Goals

HopeBox's mission and activities align with several United Nations Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs) (United Nations, 2023). Most notably, it contributes to SDG 5: Gender Equality, by

empowering women survivors of GBV through employment and training. HopeBox's efforts also support SDG 8: Decent Work and Economic Growth, by providing job opportunities and economic empowerment to marginalized women. Furthermore, their community outreach and awareness campaigns align with SDG 10: Reduced Inequalities, as they work towards reducing gender-based disparities and creating a more inclusive society. Through its comprehensive support model, HopeBox is making significant strides towards creating a safer and more equitable environment for women in Vietnam.

Current Challenges

HopeBox faces several significant challenges in its mission to support survivors of gender-based violence. One of the primary issues is the recruitment of women survivors. Many potential beneficiaries have family responsibilities and immediate financial pressures that make it difficult for them to participate in the program. As a result, HopeBox struggles to maintain a steady influx of participants, which directly impacts the company's ability to fulfill its mission and sustain its social enterprise model. This recruitment hurdle can lead to underutilization of resources, reduced program effectiveness, and ultimately, a diminished capacity to generate the positive social impact that HopeBox aims to achieve.

In addition to recruitment challenges, HopeBox also struggles with ensuring stable revenue streams. HopeBox currently has 3 main revenue streams: (1) selling food products and gifts, (2) providing cooking and baking training classes, and (3) providing social study tours. The company's primary strategy involves engaging with corporate customers to stably receive revenue throughout the year. However, their engagement with partners currently is concentrated for specific seasons such as Christmas, Tết, Mid-Autumn, etc. leading to a significant portion of their revenue being generated in the second half of the year. Having said that, HopeBox's business is currently very seasonal. Exploring how Hopebox can increase their business and revenue during the first half of the year is a problem they need to solve.

More information about HopeBox

- https://hopeboxvn.com/
- <Link to pdf file (to be updated)>

Additional materials

- https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=6bohxwZRj1Y&feature=youtu.be
- https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=v3ViPR6clDE
- www.youtube.com/watch?v=eryixyp5XKk
- https://www.facebook.com/tintucvtv24/videos/811933496497075\

- https://vtvgo.vn/vod/818964?fbclid=IwAR2sgF-DHYfLEa9eXR3lsl5tDiKfdfZIyU5fBvxergCKXSlOcet33IdESSk
- https://www.facebook.com/watch/?v=252960376308797
- https://www.australianvolunteers.com/about/stories/giving-hope-to-survivors-of-gender-based-violence-in-vietnam/
- https://www.allens.com.au/about/impact/delivering-hope-in-vietnam-hopebox

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References

MOLISA, GSO and UNFPA (2020), National Study on Violence against Women in Viet Nam 2019 - Journey for Change. https://vietnam.unfpa.org/sites/default/files/pub-pdf/0._vaw_study_main_report_final_13_aug_2020.pdf.

United Nations (2023). The Sustainable Development Goals Report 2023. https://unstats.un.org/sdgs/report/2023/